

Answer ALL questions.

NOTE: When the question asks you to answer in your own words, YOU MUST NOT COPY THE WORDS IN THE PASSAGE IN YOUR ANSWER.

From Paragraph 1

[Literal]

1. What made the canoe difficult to balance? State two reasons.

The sides of the canoe were high but its draught is ^{so} ~~decidedly shallow~~ and the slightest movement ~~tended~~ ^{to send} the canoe lurching to one side.

[2]

From Paragraph 2

[Interpretive]

2. What does Jack's reply to the narrator tell us about his knowledge of crocodiles?

It tells us that Jack is knowledgeable ^{on} crocodiles. ^{not answering the question as the extent of knowledge is not captured.} DNA: ^{knows}

(He is ^{not that good} very knowledgeable about crocodiles. / He is very familiar with crocodiles. / He has a lot of ^{experience} experience with crocodiles.) [1]

3. "He was sweeping the beam of his powerful torch across the water in front of him" (lines 11-12).

DNA: calm / confident / concentrated / determined

[Interpretive]

What does this action imply about Jack's state of mind?

It implies that he is ^{not accurate} calm. ^{calm is not alert} (He was alert, cautious, focused, determined / hoping / very keen / really wanted to find a crocodile. / Concentrating very hard on looking for a crocodile.) [1]

From Paragraph 3

4a. "our monstrous aggressor would... use the boat's splinters like giant wooden toothpicks" (lines 16-18).

[Use of Language]

DNA: Imagery, Metaphor, Personification:

Identify the literary device in this expression.

NOT ARAFE / Imagery is too broad

The literary device is simile

[1]

DNA: Aggressive/monstrous (it is in the text)
• Imagery (if student gives this as the only answer)

Answer: Accept any logical answer. Answers must convey either the crocodile's enormous size/power to the vulnerability of the boat/character. Why does the writer use this device?

4b. Explain the effect of this literary device.

It compares the ~~sp~~ boat's splinters to giant wooden toothpicks to show the crocodile's huge ~~jaws~~ size. [1]

X Answer wants to make the image vivid for us / he wants to help us imagine the scene (DOES NOT show?)
5. In your own words, explain what the narrator thought about his decision to join the expedition. (Use your own words) Stop

The narrator thought that he was dumb to join the expedition as he did not have a good reason. (vague)

Rational "and explanation" must be paraphrased.

(He realised the trip was foolish/stupid/idiotic/reckless/rash/impulsive/unwise and he had no sensible/logical reason for joining it / could not come up with a reasonable answer.) DNA: Silly/copy (infernal)

From Paragraph 4

X DNA: if "rational" missing/clueless reason: Did not know why he wanted to join the expedition. Not sure why he wanted to join in the first place

Answers that show Jack's attention is on his surroundings.

6. Suggest a reason why Jack "murmured without interest" (lines 21-22) when he answered the question. [Inferential] X

Jack was ~~only~~ not interested in ~~finding~~ telling the difference between a big crocodile and a small one. [1]

(He is not distracted by the question as he is focused on the finding the crocodile.) DNA: Direct lifting from lines 22-23

From Paragraph 5 (He was busy trying to find a crocodile.) [Literal] He is concentrating on the torch beam ahead of him. (lifted)

7. What unpleasant sounds accompanied the canoe as it moved along?

The ~~sound~~ sound of frogs and the pneumatic buzzing of ~~mosquito~~ mosquitoes and other flying insects accompanied the canoe.

(The sound of frogs that resonated like castanets in the distance.) [2]

Lift directly, do not miss out words

Answers that are not inferred from contextual clues
• The question is a boring one

[Turn over

8. In your own words, explain why the narrator was uncomfortable during this part of the journey.

Extent 1 ✓
 There were many mosquitoes biting him when as
 he did not use insect repellent. He was also X — describing
 annoyed by the constant buzzing of insects and the 1/2
 noises from the frogs. [2]

From Paragraph 7 Reasoning must be logical and inferred from context accurately.
 Overall answer must capture before and after. Use transitional
 9. Why does Jack only admit the danger after initially denying it? [Inferential] like "Before" and "After"

Jack thought that was trying to let the narrator to join
 the expedition and thought that the chances of
 encountering a daddy crocodile was not likely. 0/2

(He does not want to ~~start~~ alarm/scare the narrator [1] / He is trying
 to reassure the narrator. [1] / He prefers not to emphasise the risk. [1]) [2]

From Paragraph 9 (There is still a possibility of danger. [1] / He wanted the
 narrator to know what to do in an event of a crocodile attack.) First Part (before)
 10. According to Jack, what action should the narrator take, and what should he avoid, if he ends up in the water? [Literal] on the water Second part (after)

The narrator should not splash and should dive
 under water before swimming away. 2/2

[2]

11. "I had noted that he had said crocs *rarely* bite underwater and that it was *unlikely* to follow me" (lines 54–55).

Paying attention to the words in italics, how does Jack feel about the danger posed by crocodiles?

chances of [inferential] Do interpret it directly.
 Jack feels that the dangers posed by crocodiles were ^x very low. (There is still some danger present [1] / The danger is rare but not impossible. [1] / There is still a risk involved.) 0/1

From Paragraph 13

12. Identify a word which shows that the swamp no longer seems threatening.

[Use of language] 1/1
 The word is "indifferent". [1]

From Paragraph 14

13. What does the phrase "breathing more freely" (line 89) suggest about how the narrator feels at this point?

^x
 It suggests that the narrator is feeling calm. 0/1
 (He feels relaxed / at ease / relieved.) [1]

DNA

. calm

~~ret~~

14. Using your own words as far as possible, summarise the narrator's actions, thoughts, and feelings as he travelled through the swamp.

USE ONLY MATERIAL FROM PARAGRAPHS 6 TO 9.

Your summary must be in continuous writing (not note form). **It must not be longer than 120 words** (NOT counting the words given below). Indicate the word count at the end of your summary.

Begin your summary as follows:

I followed the torch beam but spotted nothing ^① and as we advanced ^② on the crocodile, it disappeared. So, we stayed briefly to ^③ observe if it would appear, but it did not. Thus, we rowed ^④ on again, ~~too~~ but I was not sad to have missed it, I had ^⑤ been attempting to get Jack to confess that what we ^⑥ were doing was risky, but he did not. I shut my ^⑦ eyes and racked my head in vain hope that this ^⑧ would be a ~~nightmare~~ ^{nightmare}. ~~Furthermore,~~ ^{Furthermore,} I asked if ^⑨ we fell in the water what ^⑩ to do ^⑪ and he said to ^⑫ not tread and go underwater ^⑬ ~~inswim~~ ^{swim} and swim away. ^⑭ ~~quinted~~ ^{quinted} ~~down~~ ^{down} While I ^⑮ analysed this information, The whole escape ^⑯ had been preposterous. ^⑰ ~~too~~

Crocodile almost never bite ~~underwater~~ and was not likely to follow you.

- 1 On a rooftop near O'Connell Bridge, a sniper lay watching. Beside him lay his rifle and over his shoulders was slung a pair of field glasses. His face was the face of a student but his eyes had the cold gleam of the fanatic. They were deep and thoughtful, the eyes of a man who was used to looking at death. 5
- 2 Just then an armoured car came across the bridge and advanced slowly up the street. It stopped on the opposite side of the street, fifty yards ahead. The sniper could hear the dull panting of the motor. It was an enemy car. He wanted to fire, but he knew it was useless. His bullets would never pierce the steel that covered the grey monster. 10
- 3 Then round the corner of a side street came an old woman, her head covered by a tattered shawl. She began to talk to the man in the turret of the car. She was pointing to the roof where the sniper lay. An informer.
- 4 The turret opened. A man's head and shoulders appeared, looking toward the sniper. The sniper raised his rifle and fired. The head fell heavily on the turret wall. The woman darted toward the side street. The sniper fired again. The woman whirled round and fell with a shriek into the gutter. 15
- 5 Suddenly, from the opposite roof a shot rang out and the sniper dropped his rifle. The rifle clattered to the roof. The sniper thought the noise would wake the dead. He stooped to pick the rifle up. He couldn't lift it. His forearm was dead. "I'm hit," he muttered. 20
- 6 Dropping flat onto the roof, he crawled back to the parapet. With his left hand he felt the injured right forearm. The blood was oozing through the sleeve of his coat. There was no pain – just a deadened sensation, as if the arm had been cut off. Not answering his 25
- 7 Quickly he drew his knife from his pocket, opened it on the breastwork of the parapet, and ripped open the sleeve. There was a small hole where the bullet had entered. On the other side there was no hole. The bullet had lodged in the bone. It must have fractured it. He bent the arm below the wound. The arm bent back easily. He ground his teeth to overcome the pain. 30
- 8 Then taking out his field dressing, he ripped open the packet with his knife. He broke the neck of the iodine bottle and let the bitter fluid drip into the wound. A paroxysm of pain swept through him. He placed the cotton wadding over the wound and wrapped the dressing over it. He tied the ends with his teeth. 35
- 9 He pressed the wadding on the wound and covered it with dressing.

~~He leaned on the parapet~~
10

- 9 Then he lay still against the parapet, and, closing his eyes, he made an effort of will to overcome the pain. (8)
- 10 The sniper lay still for a long time nursing his wounded arm and planning escape. Morning must not find him wounded on the roof. The enemy on the opposite roof covered his escape. He must kill that enemy and he could not use his rifle. He had only a revolver to do it. Then he thought of a plan. (8) 40 plotting an escape. 10
- 11 Removing " covered thoughts 12 10 9
Taking off his cap, he placed it over the muzzle of his rifle. Then he pushed the rifle slowly upward over the parapet, until the cap was visible from the opposite side of the street. Almost immediately there was a report, and a bullet pierced the centre of the cap. The sniper slanted the rifle forward. The cap clipped down into the street. Then catching the rifle in the middle, the sniper dropped his left hand over the roof and let it hang, lifelessly. After a few moments he let the rifle drop to the street. Then he sank to the roof, dragging his hand with him. (13) 14
- 12 Crawling quickly to his feet, he peered up at the corner of the roof. His ruse had succeeded. The other sniper, seeing the cap and rifle fall, thought that he had killed his man. He was now standing with his head clearly silhouetted against the western sky. (15) 15 55
- 13 The sniper grimaced and lifted his revolver above the edge of the parapet. The distance was about fifty yards – a hard shot in the dim light, and his right arm was hurting him like a thousand devils. He took a steady aim. His hand trembled with eagerness. Pressing his lips together, he took a deep breath through his nostrils and fired. He was almost deafened with the report and his arm shook with the recoil. 16 1 raised my revolver and took steady aim. After taking a deep breath, I shot 8 60 18
- 14 Then when the smoke cleared, he peered across and uttered a cry of joy. His enemy had been hit. He was reeling over the parapet in his death agony. Then the dying man on the roof crumpled up and fell forward. The body turned over and over in space and hit the ground with a dull thud. Then it lay still. 65
- 15 The sniper looked at his enemy falling and he shuddered. The lust of battle died in him. He became bitten by remorse. He was revolted from the sight of the shattered mass of his dead enemy. His teeth chattered, he began to gibber to himself, cursing the war, cursing himself, cursing everybody. 70
- 16 He decided to leave the roof now and look for his company commander, to report. Everywhere around was quiet. There was not much danger in going through the streets. He picked up his revolver and put it in his 75

[Turn over

pocket. Then he crawled down through the skylight to the house underneath.

- 17 When the sniper reached the laneway on the street level, he felt a sudden curiosity as to the identity of the enemy sniper whom he had killed. He decided that he was a good shot, whoever he was. He wondered did he know him. He decided to risk going over to have a look at him. He peered around the corner into O'Connell Street. In the upper part of the street there was heavy firing, but around here all was quiet. 80
- 18 The sniper darted across the street. A machine gun tore up the ground around him with a hail of bullets, but he escaped. He threw himself face downward beside the corpse. The machine gun stopped. 85
- 19 Then the sniper turned over the dead body and looked into his brother's face. 90

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Answer ALL questions.

NOTE: When the question asks you to answer in your own words, YOU MUST NOT COPY THE WORDS IN THE PASSAGE IN YOUR ANSWER.

From Paragraph 1

1. Pick **ONE** phrase from this paragraph which shows the sniper had faced dangerous situations before.

The phrase is "the eyes of a man who was used to the face of death". [1]

From Paragraph 2

2. The armoured car was compared to a "grey monster." (Line 10)

Identify the literary device used here.

Metaphor. [1]

From Paragraph 3

3. Suggest **ONE** reason why the sniper shot the old woman.

The old woman would expose the sniper's location to his enemies. [1]

From Paragraph 6

4. "Dropping flat onto the roof, he crawled back to the parapet." (Line 24)

Identify **ONE** word in the sentence given which suggests "stealth."

The word is "crawled". [1]

For Examiner's Use

For Examiner's Use

5. "There was no pain – just a deadened sensation, as if the arm had been cut off." (Lines 26-27)

Explain how the phrase "deadened sensation" is effective in describing the sniper's injury.

The phrase "deadened sensation" ^{shows} ~~means~~ that ^{his} ~~he~~ arm ~~was felt~~ was shot and felt nothing ~~as his arm~~ could not feel his arm. ~~Since his arm was shot,~~ ^{was immediately gone.} Thus, it ~~show~~ is effective in describing ^{his injury.} ~~how his arm is~~. [2]

From Paragraphs 7 – 9

6. Identify TWO character traits the sniper exhibited after he was wounded.

He was ~~brave~~ and ~~experienced~~.

[2]

From Paragraph 8

7. Pick ONE word that suggests that the pain the sniper felt was sharp and sudden.

The word is "paroxysm".

[1]

From Paragraph 10

8. What dilemma did the sniper face after he was wounded by the enemy sniper?

The sniper could not use his rifle to kill the enemy and escape and he could only use his revolver, but the sniper was worried that he would miss and expose his location to the enemy. [2]

For Examiner's Use

For Examiner's Use

[Turn over

From Paragraph 11

9. How did the sniper plan to deceive the enemy sniper?

The sniper removed ~~the~~ his cap and hung ~~it~~ over the rifle, then he warily lifted the rifle till it was noticeable from the other side of the street. This made the enemy think that it was the sniper, so he would immediately shoot it thinking ~~enemy~~ ^{the sniper} is dead. Then, the sniper would use his revolver and kill the enemy. [2]

From Paragraph 13

10. The writer uses the expressions, "a hard shot in the dim light" and "like a thousand devils." (Lines 59-60)

Explain **IN YOUR OWN WORDS**, what the expressions reveal about the difficulties the sniper faced in shooting his target.

The sniper's right arm was hurting ~~alot~~ and he felt that the distance between him and the enemy is really far ~~for~~ and it would not be easy to ~~shoot~~ ^{hit} him. [2]

From Paragraph 14

11. Identify the expression, which suggests that the enemy sniper will not survive the shot.

The expression is "in his death agony" [1]

From Paragraph 15

12. Explain, **IN YOUR OWN WORDS**, **TWO** emotions felt by the sniper after he had succeeded in killing his opponent.

The sniper felt ~~guilty~~ and ~~excited~~ ^{really??} as he had killed his enemy but he was disgusted by ~~the~~ all the enemies he had killed and regret what he did.

same Excess Denied C-1)

[2]

From Paragraph 19

13. The writer ends the story with "Then the sniper turned over the dead body and looked into his **brother's face**." (Lines 89-90)

Explain the **irony** of this ending.

The sniper thought that the ^{other} people he sniper he had killed was an enemy. However, ^{who he actually} ~~he~~ realise killed was his own brother.

repeatedly events only.

[2]

For Examiner's Use

For Examiner's Use

[Turn over]

14. Imagine you are the sniper

Using your own words as far as possible, summarise what you did from the moment you were shot by the enemy sniper till the time you shot him in return.

Use ONLY material from paragraphs 6 to 13.

Your summary must be in continuous writing (not note form). It must not be more than 120 words, excluding the opening words provided below to help you begin. Indicate the word count at the end of your summary.

After I was hit I ~~climbed~~ ¹ to the parapet, and ~~took~~ ² out my knife and ~~tore~~ ³ open the sleeve. I ~~cut~~ ⁴ open the field dressing ⁵ packet, ~~twisted~~ ⁶ the neck of the bottle and let the fluid flow into the wound. Then, I pressed the wadding on the wound before making a ⁷ knot. Remaining motionless, I treated my arm ⁸ and plotted an escape. Removing ⁹ my cap, I covered it over my rifle. Then I raised the ¹⁰ rifle steadily over the parapet. After a bullet ¹¹ shot the cap, I hung my arm ~~over~~ ¹² the roof and let my rifle fall to the street. After the enemy stood up, I raised my revolver and took ~~steady~~ ¹³ aim. Taking a deep breath, I took a shot. ¹⁴

For Examiner's Use

For Examiner's Use

C-11/12

L-5/8

16/20

Generally focused,
w some attempts at
successful
paraphrasing.

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Class: 102

Comprehension Skills: Question Types

This worksheet will take you through the various types of comprehension questions, and how to approach them.

1. Literal Questions

Literal questions assess your ability to read and identify information directly from the passage.

Locate your answer by identifying:

- **Keywords** in the question,
- Words in the passage that are similar to those keywords,
- Information in the passage that is related to those keywords, or
- Synonyms (e.g. for a question asking for an explanation, look for words like "because")

How can you identify literal questions? They commonly contain keywords or phrases like "Cite the reason ...", "State why ...", "What are the factors ...".

Practice

Passage: When Mary Lennox was sent to Misselthwaite Manor to live with her uncle, everybody said she was the most disagreeable-looking child ever seen. It was true, too. She had a little thin face and a little thin body, thin light hair and a sour expression. Her hair was yellow, and her face was yellow because she had been born in India and had always been ill in one way or another. Her father had held a position under the English Government and had always been busy and ill himself, and her mother had been a great beauty who cared only to go to parties and amuse herself with happy people.

Q. Identify TWO physical qualities that made Mary "the most disagreeable-looking child ever seen". [2m]

[Note: Excess denied applies.] – when you write more than what is expected, 1m will be deducted from the final mark.

Answer: She had a little thin face and a sour expression

What are the keywords in this question that help you locate your answer?

two physical qualities, disagreeable & looking

2. Inferential Questions

Inferential questions require answers that cannot be identified directly in the passage, but require further thinking based on the relevant information.

2a. Writer or speaker's tone or attitude

Tone expresses the writer or speaker's **attitude or feelings** towards something.

How can you determine tone or attitude?:

- Study [1] the choice of **words or phrases** used, and [2] the **context** in the passage (i.e. what situation is being discussed?)
- Before answering the question specifically, establish whether the tone and attitude is positive or negative first
 - Note: BUT **do not** provide **vague** answers like "positive" or "negative"!

Practice ['Lord of the Rings/ The Hobbit (?)']

Passage: Otho would have been Bilbo's heir, but for the adoption of Frodo. He read the will carefully and snorted. It was, unfortunately, very clear and correct. "Foiled again!" he said to his wife. "And after waiting sixty years. Fiddlesticks!" He snapped his fingers under Frodo's nose and stomped off.

Q. What attitude did Otho display when he "snorted" as he read the will? [1m]

Answer: Frustration / ~~Angry~~ Annoyed / Disgusted / Displeased / Contemptuous / Irritated
(?)
[wrong context/ lacking meaning]

[too mild, does not capture the intensity of Otho's emotions]

2b. Figurative language (e.g. metaphor, simile, irony, contradiction etc)

There are a few ways in which you may be asked about figurative language:

Identification of literary device [Simile, Metaphor, Personification etc]

- Here, you have to know and be able to identify the characteristics and effects of various literary devices.

Practice ["Sredni Vashtar"]

Q. "In the dull, cheerless garden, overlooked by so many windows that were ready to open with a message not to do this or that..." (Lines 17 – 18).

Identify the literary device used in the underlined expression. [1m]

Answer: Personification

M/W: find out → What's a
1) Simile — e.g.
definition of
2) metaphor — e.g.
3) Personification — e.g.
Write on Journal

Explaining irony or contradiction ★

- Irony: The discrepancy between what is expected and what actually occurs in reality, i.e. something is expected but the opposite or the unexpected happens
- Your answer must thus consist of 2 parts:
 - [1] What is expected
 - [2] The actual reality (that is unexpected)
- To clearly show the irony, use words and phrases like:
 - [1] "one would expect", "usually", etc
 - [2] "but", "however", etc

Practice ["Sredni Vashtar"]

Q. Explain clearly, the irony in the last paragraph of the story. [2m]

Answer: The other ~~people~~ people in the story ^{use a ~~contrast~~ contrasting connector to show the contrast/contradiction} assumed the boy would be devastated by the death of his cousin. However, Conradin was not bothered about it / was celebrating his freedom from his cousin by eating another piece of toast.

Explaining metaphor or simile

In explaining a metaphor or simile, your answer should consist of these 3 components:

- [1] The **literal meaning** of the metaphor or simile (i.e. what is the object of comparison?)
- [2] The **contextual meaning** of the metaphor or simile (i.e. what does this comparison mean in the context of the passage?)
- [3] A **comparative word or phrase linking** the literal and contextual meaning together (e.g. 'similarly', 'in the same way')

Example

Q. Why does the writer compare people who lack independence with 'aimless mice scampering for food'?

Answer: Aimless mice scurry around not knowing where the food might be [**literal meaning**]. Similarly [**comparative word**], people who lack independence are clueless about their goals in life [**contextual meaning**].



Practice ["Sredni Vashtar"]

Q. What is the writer's purpose in mentioning the "many windows"? [1m]

Answer: Mentioning "many windows" is to show that Conradin ~~is~~ was given any freedom for the many windows.
or... to show how Mrs De Ropp was controlling Conradin
or... ~~to~~ suggest that she had put many restrictions on him.

2c. Vocabulary or language

- Explain the vocabulary or language in the context of the passage, as opposed to merely providing the literal/dictionary meaning
- Be aware of the intensity or degree suggested by the vocabulary or language, and capture this accurately in your answer

Practice

① Passage: One year of waiting turned into two, then three, then four. Finally, Mathews and his team could return to El Cayo, and none too soon. Looters had already tried to claw the altar from its resting place. Mathews hoped the monument could help the local Indians. A plan had been devised recently with villagers from Frontera Corozal, about 20 miles southeast of El Cayo, to transfer the altar to that central location. It would be kept there temporarily until El Cayo could be opened to tourists, who would bring in much needed capital and jobs. The hope was shared by Mathews's Mexican colleagues — Mario Aliphath and Armando Anaya. With them on the mission to rescue the altar was Chayo Magana, an experienced dig supervisor.

Q. "With them on the mission to rescue the altar was Chayo Magana, an experienced dig supervisor." (lines 18-19). What does the word "rescue" suggest about the mission? [1m]

Answer: The word "rescue" suggests that the mission is ~~dangerous~~. / It suggests that the altar is ~~in~~ in desperate need of being recovered. / It suggests that the mission is an urgent one.

... a difficult and risky one.

(It suggest that it was urgent and necessary to save the altar from destruction ~~of~~ or to prevent it from being stolen or destroyed.)



2d. Use of Logic

Such questions require your general knowledge of the relevant issue, and cannot be answered by merely identifying or paraphrasing parts of the passage.

How can you identify these questions? They commonly contain keywords or phrases like "Suggest", "Why do you think..."

Practice

- 1 Passage: Peter Mathews wiped the sweat from his face and readjusted a red bandanna across his forehead. It was June 25, 1997, and the jungles along the Usumacinta River in the Mexican state of Chiapas were streaming in the mid-day heat. The 46-year-old Canadian archeology professor revelled in these surroundings. Amid the ancient ruins of El Cayo, the quiet father of two was in his element. Stepping into a shallow trench, he knelt before an ancient altar. He ran his fingers over the finely carved figure of the noble ruler Ah Chak Wayib, whose squat likeness adorned the circular one-ton monument. Mathews's archaeological team had discovered the altar in the summer of 1993. But the team reburied the relic until authorities could further develop it as a possible tourist attraction.

Q. Why do you think there was a need for the team to rebury the altar? [1m]

Answer: The altar was in danger of looters and they ~~wanted~~ needed to wait a few years until authorities could develop it into a tourist attraction. So, they buried the altar.

(This is to prevent the altar from being stolen.)

(This is to prevent the authorities or other agencies from taking action before

3. "Use Your Own Words" Questions

Such questions assess your ability to paraphrase relevant parts of the passage. You must:

1. Identify the relevant information from the passage for your answer formal at authorisation or permission is given to do sth.)
2. Identify the keywords from the relevant information
3. Paraphrase the keywords
4. DO NOT re-use any of the given words

* No marks will be awarded if you do not paraphrase the keywords.

(This is done to decrease the chance of the altar being damaged by external factors or threats.)